



Driver's License and State ID Card Information

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Driver's License Application

To obtain an Illinois driver's license you must:

- Visit a [DMV](#), show required identification documents, and have your photo taken.
- Surrender all valid out-of-state licenses, state ID cards, instruction permits, and commercial driver's licenses.
- Pay the appropriate [fee](#).
- Pass any required exams (vision screening, written, and/or driving).

When you've completed the necessary requirements, you'll be issued a temporary, secure paper driver's license, valid for 90 days. This temporary paper credential will serve as your driver's license for driving purposes and proof of identification until your permanent card in the mail within 15 business days.

If you are under 21, please review the [Graduated Driver's License](#) page.

If you wish to apply for a REAL ID driver's license or state ID, visit [REALID.ilsos.gov](#) for more information.

Temporary Paper Credential

As of July 2016, when you apply for a driver's license, commercial driver's license (CDL), state ID card, or commercial learner's (CLP) for any card type (new, renewal, duplicate, or corrected), you will not receive your permanent card at the end of your DMV visit. Instead, you will leave the facility with a temporary, secure paper document called a Temporary Driver's License, Temporary State ID Card, Temporary CDL, or Temporary CLP. This document will:

- be valid for 90 days,
- serve as your driver's license or learner's permit for driving purposes,
- serve as proof of identification,
- contain a photo and the basic information that appears on the permanent cards, and
- can be duplicated at a [DMV](#) for the appropriate fee, if lost or stolen.

You are permitted to hold only one of these temporary credentials at a time. You may apply for an additional temporary credential of a different type after you have received your permanent card for the first application.

For the purpose of air travel, the DMV employee will return your old driver's license or ID card to you. The U.S. Department of Homeland Security (DHS) states they will accept the temporary driver's license or ID in conjunction with the expired driver's license or ID card to board an aircraft until you receive the permanent card in the mail. After the necessary checks have been conducted to ensure your identity, a secure, permanent driver's license, state ID card, CDL, or CLP will be printed and sent via U.S. mail to your address on file within 15 business days. It is imperative that you ensure the address you provide is correct.

If you lose your temporary driver's license, state ID card, CDL, or CLP credential, you can obtain a duplicate temporary credential for the appropriate fee.

If you do not receive your new permanent driver's license, state ID card, CDL, or CLP within 15 business days of obtaining your temporary credential, you can [check your card's mailing status online](#) or call 217-782-7044.

Mobile ID

Mobile ID is an optional and secure digital version of your Illinois Secretary of State issued driver's license or state ID available on your iPhone and Apple Watch (Google and Samsung coming soon). With Mobile ID, there's no need to hand over your physical card or your device, allowing for contactless acceptance. Mobile ID serves as a companion to your physical driver's license or state ID. You still need to carry your physical ID with you. Learn more on our [Mobile ID support page](#).

Renewal of Driver's License or Commercial Driver's License

Renewal Notice

If you are a driver's license holder, the Secretary of State's office will mail a renewal letter to you 60 to 90 days prior to the expiration of your license. The letter is mailed to the address our office has on file for your driving record. The letter contains the information needed to renew your license. Testing requirements and [fees](#) vary depending on the type of license being renewed.

Temporary License

When you renew your license, you will leave the DMV with a temporary, secure paper driver's license that is valid for 90 days and will serve as your driver's license for driving purposes and proof of identification. The temporary, secure paper driver's license will contain a photo and the basic information that appears on the permanent driver's license. In addition, the DMV employee will return your old driver's license to you.

For purposes of air travel, the U.S. Department of Homeland Security (DHS) states that it will accept the temporary, secure paper driver's license in conjunction with the old driver's license to board an aircraft until the permanent card arrives in the mail.

Permanent Card

Meanwhile, your information will be sent to a centralized, secure facility in Illinois. After fraud checks have been conducted to verify your identity, a higher-quality, more-secure driver's license will be printed and sent via U.S. mail to your address on file within 10 business days.

You must ensure your address is updated with the Secretary of State's office to receive your permanent driver's license. By law, address changes must be reported within 10 days. If you are an Illinois resident, you can [update your address online](#). If you do not, you must receive your new permanent driver's license within 15 business days, [check the mailing status online](#) or call 217-782-7044.

Renewal Requirements

- [Acceptable identification](#) is required.
- Vision screening is required for all drivers renewing at a facility.
- You must take a written exam every 8 years if you have traffic convictions. If you have an accident recorded on your driving record, you may be required to take the written or road exams.
- As of July 1, 2026, all persons age 87 and older must take a driving exam and renew yearly.
- If you are required to take a drive exam, you must present proof of liability insurance on your vehicle.
- **For Commercial Driver's License renewal only**, if you have not provided your [Proof of Legal Presence](#), you must provide [the required documentation](#) to renew your CDL. For more information, please see the [Commercial Driver's License](#) section.

Renewal Timelines

- You can renew up to one year before your 4-year or 2-year license expires, or 6 months before a one-year license expires.
- Drivers under age 21 — licenses expire three months after 21st birthday.
- Drivers ages 21 through 86 — licenses are valid for 4 years and expire on a driver's birthday.
- Drivers age 87 and older must renew their licenses each year.

Address Change

- By law, you must notify the Secretary of State's office of an address or name change within 10 days. You may submit an [address change form](#) electronically, but you must still visit a [Secretary of State facility](#) prior to expiration of your license. For a name change, you must provide identification with your new name and identification that links the old and new names. Drivers with a valid CDL must notify the Secretary of State's office of an address or name change within 10 days and must obtain a corrected driver's license within 30 days.

Military Duty

Members of the U.S. Armed Forces on active duty outside Illinois, as well as their spouses and children, may drive with an expired license for up to 120 days after their return to the state. A Military Deferral Certificate(s) must be carried with your expired Illinois driver's license. Certificates are available at no charge and may be mailed to your out-of-state address.

To request a Military Deferral Certificate, mail a copy of your current Illinois driver's license, a copy of the front and back of your Military ID Card, and your out-of-state address to:

Secretary of State
License and Medical Review Unit
2701 S. Dirksen Pkwy.
Springfield, IL 62723

Or you can email militarydeferral@ilsos.gov.

For more information, please call 217-782-2720.

Out-of-State Driver's License Renewal

Illinois residents who are temporarily outside the State of Illinois (military assignment, snowbird, college student, work assignment, emergency family responsibility, etc.) may be eligible to apply for a renewal of their driver's license while they are out-of-state. The applicant will be required to successfully complete any required exams (vision, written, driving), provide acceptable documentation, and pay the appropriate renewal fee. For more information about this process, please call 217-782-2720.

Duplicate or Corrected Driver's License or Commercial Driver's License

Duplicate License

A duplicate license contains the same information as the original license. You can apply for a duplicate license if your license is lost, stolen, or destroyed. If you provide a police report showing your license was stolen, you'll receive a free replacement.

To apply for a duplicate license, visit your nearest [DMV](#) and provide [acceptable identification](#). You will leave the facility with a temporary, secure paper driver's license that is valid for 90 days and will serve as your driver's license or state ID for driving purposes and proof of identification. The temporary, secure paper card will contain a photo and the basic information that appears on your permanent driver's license or state ID card. In addition, the DMV employee will return your old driver's license or state ID card to you. Your permanent duplicate license will be mailed to your address on file within 15 business days.

Corrected License

A corrected license involves a change to the information on the original license, such as name or address. To obtain a corrected license, you must visit a [DMV](#), turn in your incorrect license, and provide [acceptable identification](#).

By law, you must notify the Secretary of State's office of an address or name change within 10 days. You may submit an address

change form electronically, but you must still visit a [DMV](#) prior to expiration of your license to update your card. For a name change, you must provide identification with your new name and identification that links your old and new names. Drivers who hold a valid license must notify the Secretary of State's office of an address or name change within 10 days and must obtain a corrected driver's license within 30 days.

Once all necessary requirements are completed for the corrected license, you'll be issued a temporary driver's license on second paper. Your permanent driver's license will be mailed within 15 business days.

Please see [air travel rules](#).

Name Change

If your name changes, you must apply for a corrected driver's license or state ID. To obtain a corrected license or state ID, visit your [nearest DMV](#) to turn in your incorrect license or ID card and provide [acceptable identification](#).

You must present:

- One document that satisfies Group A and one document from Group D (if requesting an address change).
- For a change in name — as well as date of birth, Social Security number, or gender — you must provide documentation that shows the change from the previous information to the new information.

Gender Change

To change the gender that appears on your driver's license or ID card, you must submit a Secretary of State [Gender Designation](#) form. If you change the gender designation when renewing your license or ID, there is no additional fee. At any time other than renewal, there is a \$5 fee for a corrected driver's license and a \$10 fee for a corrected ID card.

Lost, Found, or Stolen Driver's License, Commercial Driver's License, or State ID Card

Contact your local police department as soon as possible to report your lost or stolen driver's license. If you find a driver's license or state ID, please return it to a [DMV](#) or local police department.

If you think you may be a victim of identity theft, the [Federal Trade Commission](#) has developed an Identity Theft brochure that helps identity theft victims to report information to many companies using just one standardized form.

To obtain a duplicate license:

- In Illinois, apply at any [DMV](#). You must provide acceptable identification and pay a fee. You will be issued a temporary driver's license at the facility. Your permanent driver's license will be mailed within 15 business days.
- If you are out of state, call the License and Medical Review Section at 217-782-2720 for information and to have an application for a duplicate driver's license mailed to your out-of-state address. You also can request an application for a duplicate driver's license by emailing the Secretary of State's office with your full name, date of birth, Illinois driver's license number, and out-of-state address.
- Please see [air travel rules](#).

Motorcycle License

Operation of a motorcycle or motor-driven cycle in the State of Illinois requires a valid license with the proper classification.

- **Class L** is any motor-driven cycle with less than 150cc displacement.
- **Class M** is any motorcycle with 150cc or greater displacement.

Requirements

- If you are a first-time applicant and do not hold a valid Illinois driver's license, you must successfully complete a vision screening, written (basic and motorcycle) exam, and a drive exam. Applicable fees and acceptable identification are required. You will be issued a temporary driver's license at the facility, and a permanent driver's license will be mailed within 15 business days.
- You do not have to take the drive exam if you present an IDOT Motorcycle Rider Course Student Completion Card. Applicable [fees](#) and [acceptable identification](#) are required.
- If you are a member of the U.S. Armed Forces on active duty outside Illinois, you may be eligible to add a motorcycle classification to your Illinois driver's license with the completion of the Motorcycle Safety Foundation's Basic Rider Course offered at your military base. For more information and to request an application for motorcycle upgrade, please contact 217-782-2720.

For more information, please review the [Motorcycle Operator Manual](#) and the [Illinois Rules of the Road](#).

Social Security Online Verification

The Secretary of State's office verifies Social Security numbers with the Social Security Administration prior to issuance or renewal of a driver's license or state ID card to verify name, date of birth, and Social Security number. If records cannot be verified, the driver's license or state ID card will not be issued.

State ID Cards and State ID Card Online Renewal

Illinois-issued state ID cards provide photo identification for Illinois residents and prove identity when banking, traveling, and in other situations. Children traveling on airplanes may need identification of this type to fly (see [air travel rules](#)). More information about state ID cards is available in the [Illinois Rules of the Road](#).

Our office mails a state ID renewal letter to the address on file for your card 60 to 90 days prior to expiration. The letter contains information needed to [renew your State ID Card online](#). You can print a temporary state ID card after completing the online renewal transaction.

To obtain a new state ID card, please visit a [DMV](#). You will be issued a temporary ID card at the facility, and your permanent card will be mailed within 15 business days.

- There is no minimum age for a state ID card.
- The card is issued for a [fee](#) and typically is valid for 5 years.
- **Residents over age 65:** Visit a [DMV](#) to apply for a free non-expiring state ID card.
- **Persons with Disabilities:** Apply at a [DMV](#) for a free 10-year state ID card. You must provide an [Application for an Illinois Person with a Disability Identification Card](#) completed by your doctor.

Do you want to apply for a **REAL ID**? Visit [REALID.ilsos.gov](#) for more information.

Restricted Local Driver's License

A Restricted Local License may be issued to qualified drivers who reside in areas with populations of 3,500 or less and who wish to drive only within a limited area, such as to the grocery store, bank, or post office. To obtain a Restricted Local License, you must:

- Visit a [DMV](#);
- Surrender your current license;
- Pass a vision exam;
- Pass a written exam (if required);
- Pay the appropriate fee; and
- Provide the route(s) you wish to travel.

DMV personnel will complete a route form and forward it along with the application to the Special License Unit for approval. Upon approval of the application and route form, a facility representative will contact you to make arrangements for the drive exam. The drive exam will be administered over the route(s) they wish to travel. Upon successful completion of the drive exam, the test results will be forwarded to the Special License Unit. You will receive your Restricted Local License by mail.

State ID for the Homeless

A person qualifies for the no-fee ID card if they are considered homeless as defined by the federal McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act, [42 U.S.C. 11302](#) or [42 U.S.C. 11434a\(2\)](#). This card is issued free of charge with the [proper documentation](#) to show proof of legal name, date of birth, Social Security number, and signature. The applicant must submit a completed [Homeless Status Certification](#).

State ID for the Youth in Care of the IL Department of Children and Family Services

A person qualifies for a no-fee ID card if they are 16-20 years old and are a Youth in Care of the [Illinois Department of Children and Family Services \(DCFS\)](#). This card is issued free of charge with the [proper documentation](#) to show proof of legal name, date of birth, Social Security number, and signature. The applicant must also bring a completed Form 906 issued by DCFS and dated no more than 30 days prior to applying for the no-fee ID card.

State ID for Persons Released from the Illinois Department of Corrections, Illinois Department of Juvenile Justice, Federal Prisons Located in Illinois, and Illinois County Jails

Persons in the custody of the Illinois Department of Corrections, the Illinois Department of Juvenile Justice (IDJJ), federal prisons located in Illinois, and Illinois county jails may be eligible for a no-fee identification card to be issued before their release.

Applicants who have not previously held an Illinois driver's license or ID card work directly with their correctional facility to obtain a certified copy of their birth certificate, have their photo taken, and complete an [Identification Card Verification Form](#). The correctional facility will electronically transmit the form, birth certificate, photo, and signature to the Secretary of State's office using a secure file transfer system mailbox. The Secretary of State will review the birth certificate and verify the Social Security number with the Social Security Administration. Upon verification, an ID card will be issued, sent to the correctional facility, and given to the applicant upon release from custody.

Applicants who have previously held an Illinois driver's license or state ID card work directly with their correctional facility to have their photo taken and complete an [Identification Card Verification Form](#). The correctional facility will electronically transmit the photo, and signature to the Secretary of State's office using a secure file transfer system mailbox. The Secretary of State will use the photo and form to find the existing record and will verify the Social Security number with the Social Security Administration. If a match is confirmed, an ID card will be issued, sent to the correctional facility, and given to the applicant upon release from custody.

An individual who has not previously held an Illinois driver's license or ID card and cannot obtain a certified copy of their birth certificate, but whose Social Security number and date of birth have been verified by their correctional facility, may be issued a 30-day temporary paper ID and 90-day hard card. To receive their ID, the applicant must visit a Secretary of State facility within 30 days of their release and present a [Verification Form to Apply for an Identification Card Upon Release from a Correctional Facility](#) completed by their correctional facility. The applicant will leave the DMV with a temporary paper ID card and will be mailed a hard card valid for 90 days. The applicant must return to a Secretary of State facility during that 90-day period and present proper documentation of Social Security number and date of birth to be issued a no-fee 5-year identification card.

Temporary Visitor Driver's License

The Secretary of State's office issues a Temporary Visitor's Driver's License (TVDL) for non-citizens of the United States who have been granted temporary, legal entry into this country, are temporarily residing in the State of Illinois, and are ineligible for a Social Security number. To be eligible for a TVDL, a foreign national must:

- Be a non-citizen of the United States residing in the State of Illinois;

- Be authorized by the U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services to be present in this country, and provide documentation with such authorization;
- Not be required to obtain a driver's license issued by the U.S. Department of State, Office of Foreign Missions;
- Provide acceptable documentation that proves name, date of birth, Illinois residency, and verification of written signature;
- Applicants age 18-20 without a valid license must present proof of successful completion of a 6-hour adult driver education training course.
- Pay the appropriate fee and successfully complete a vision screening and the appropriate written and road tests.
- A TVDL may be issued for any non-commercial class license (D, C, B, A, L, M), authorizing operation of a personal car, a vehicle that does not require a commercial driver's license (CDL), a motorcycle or a motor driven cycle.
- A TVDL is valid for 4 years or for the period of time the individual is authorized to stay in this country, whichever ends sooner.
- Individuals eligible for a TVDL may obtain an instruction permit allowing them to practice driving before taking their road test. To obtain an instruction permit, the applicant must [visit a DMV](#) and meet the requirements for obtaining a license for the first time.

Veteran Designation

To obtain a "Veteran" designation on your driver's license or state ID card you must:

- Be an honorably discharged U.S. Veteran.
- Bring your veteran's document (such as a DD214, Form 13038, Department of Defense Form DD-2 (Retired), an identification card issued under the federal Veterans Identification Card Act of 2015, a United States Department of Veterans Affairs summary of service letter, or other official Department of Defense discharge document that indicates you were honorably discharged) to a [Secretary of State facility](#).
- There is no additional cost if the "Veteran" designation is added during the renewal of your driver's license or state ID card. If you choose to add the designation before your scheduled renewal date, you may obtain an updated driver's license for \$5 or state ID card for \$10. Veterans over age 65 can obtain an updated state ID card at no charge.
- You will leave the facility with a temporary, secure paper driver's license or ID card that is valid for 90 days and will serve as your driver's license or state ID for driving purposes and proof of identification. The temporary, secure paper driver's license will have a photo and the basic information that appears on your permanent driver's license or state ID card. In addition, the facility will return your old driver's license or ID card to you.
- The SOS will verify your veteran document with the Illinois Department of Veterans' Affairs (IDVA). If the IDVA is unable to verify your honorably-discharged veteran status, you will be notified to return to a SOS facility to have the veteran designation removed from your driver's license and/or identification card.

To find your nearest Illinois Dept. of Veterans' Affairs office or to request a replacement DD-214 or Form 13038, please call 1-800-437-9824 or visit the [IDVA website](#).

Gold Star Family Designation

Beginning January 1, 2025, eligible Illinois residents can have a Gold Star Family designation added to their driver's license or state ID card. This designation is available at no cost, but renewal fees may still apply.

Who is eligible

To be eligible, you must be an immediate family member of a person who lost their life while serving in the U.S. Armed Forces, whether during peacetime or war. Immediate family members include:

- parent
- widow or widower
- child
- stepchild
- brother
- half-brother
- sister
- half-sister

How to apply

- Complete an [Affirmation of Gold Star form](#).
- Bring the completed form to [any DMV facility](#).

Deceased Notification

Upon the death of a card holder, please submit a copy of the certified death certificate along with the deceased's driver's license or state ID card (if available) to:

Secretary of State
Central Services Section
2701 S. Dirksen Pkwy.
Springfield, IL 62723

If you are a relative of the decedent and would like to keep the credential issued by the Secretary of State, please visit the attorney, coroner or nearest [Secretary of State facility](#) and fill out the Invalidation of a Driver's License, Identification Card or Permit Form. This form is promulgated pursuant to 625 ILCS 5/601.3 and 15 ILCS 335.17. If you have any questions please contact Central Services at 217-785-1424.

